

GOODWILL MEDICAL CENTRE

A community of silent heroes



AN ESSAY WRITTEN BY

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FROM A TRUE LIFE
EXPERIENCE

Not all Heroes wear capes



I could not wait for the next day, sleep avoided me entirely, as though it feared the excitement burning in my chest." Each time I closed my eyes, I saw myself already walking into the hospital, greeting people I had not yet met, imagining how the job would look like. I had just been referred, and they had informed me to come for an interview. My mind entertained questions that refused to sit still.

What would the hospital look like?

What type of people worked there?

How strict? How friendly?

I had had prior experiences elsewhere, and those memories danced in my head like masquerades preparing for a village festival. I didn't know what to expect this time.

When morning finally came, I arrived at the hospital very early — almost too early, as if punctuality itself was my interview. The atmosphere greeted me with a peacefulness I had not felt in a long while. It was September 2025: that brand of cool morning air that brushes your skin like the hand of an elder blessing a child. The flowers around the compound stood proudly, their aroma floating in the air with the confidence of queens who knew their beauty. The birds were busy with their own business, chirping and humming a melody only they could fully understand.

And beneath all these soft sounds, I could still hear the distant souls of cars whooshing by the road near the hospital. Each vehicle rushed past like someone late for destiny. Why would they situate a hospital far away from town? I asked myself, but that answer was for another time.





I walked towards the glass door, carefully — very carefully — so I would not break it on my interview day and disgrace my entire lineage. That would have been a disaster worthy of oral history. Inside, I lifted my eyes and was greeted by patients already in the waiting room, having a joint morning prayer led by a nurse. The prayer was already ending as soon as I closed my eyes to join. I opened them again quickly. The patients settled comfortably into the well-ventilated waiting room, a space that seemed to breathe with them.

Then another nurse appeared, politely greeted the patients, and began talking to them about their eye health. Her voice was thin and a little cracked, like a whistle that had served many seasons, yet there was a gentle warmth in it. She spoke with a confident spirit, mixing Igbo and English as effortlessly as a village storyteller switching between proverbs and explanations.

Her last statement was welcomed with applause. Questions followed.

Where did this nurse acquire her boldness? I thought.

The interaction pleased me deeply. I told myself that perhaps, , I too would stand that boldly and talk during my interview with Prof. Amazigo, the CEO of the hospital.

I had heard so many things about her — that she was well learned, passionate about the poor, the needy, and the forgotten in society. Before coming, I had done my own research. Her history was profound: her work with WHO, her involvement with the TY Danjuma Foundation, her commitment to humanity that eventually inspired TY Danjuma to sponsor the establishment of Goodwill...

But my thoughts were interrupted suddenly by a shout.

A man rushed into the waiting room, shouting for help.

"Please! Where is the nurse?" he cried. "My wife, please... my wife!"

The nurse at the desk quickly signalled a message to another nurse — a silent language I had not yet learned — and dashed outside herself. The second nurse disappeared into the inner passage of the hospital, her footsteps swallowed by the corridor. Moments later, she reappeared with the doctors.

The first nurse, breathing quickly, ran into another room — which I later discovered was the Accident and Emergency room — and rolled out a wheelchair, moving it outside with purpose.



Suddenly a pregnant woman was being wheeled into the reception, her face twisted with pain and fear. They hurried her straight into the labour room. The other nurse arrived with the doctors, and together they vanished into the room to begin their work.

Her husband remained in the waiting room opposite the labour room, pacing up and down like a man whose heart had left his body and entered the labour room ahead of him.

I was unsettled.

My own heart beat fast.

The patients watched in silence, many whispering audible prayers for the woman.

Questions gathered in my mind like clouds preparing for rain.

What had happened? Would she be fine? Would the baby make it?

At that moment, the interview became a secondary matter, a small thing compared to the drama of life and death unfolding before me. My curiosity refused to stay still. I wanted to know what would happen to that woman, that baby, that frightened husband who paced like a man whose shadow had run ahead of him.

But duty called.

I thanked her and stepped back into the corridor, carrying my excitement like a secret treasure.

As I walked through the hall, I realized that the inside of the hospital was more beautiful than any hospital I had ever seen. At one point, I even wondered if I had mistakenly entered a hotel. The floors shone as though they had swallowed light. The air smelled clean — not just of disinfectant, but of care. The walls stood tall, dressed in quiet elegance.

The cleaners, dressed in blue uniforms, worked with a reverence that reminded me of altar boys preparing a sacred space. The flowers outside were well shaved, arranged with artistic neatness that suggested someone cared deeply about beauty even in a place of sickness.

The nurses moved with zest — to and fro, like bees in a well-organized hive — attending to patients with warmth and promptness. No raised voices, no harsh faces. Only calm hands and gentle steps.

The passage was bubbling with people by the time I resumed duty.

Patients seeking help, staff fulfilling their roles, the soft symphony of conversations, footsteps, and distant beeping machines blending into the sound of a living, breathing hospital.

Still, a part of my mind wondered,

What happened to the pregnant woman?





Days later, after I had settled into the pharmacy as a new Pharmacist, that I gathered the courage to ask one of the nurses about the woman who had been rushed into the labour room that tuesday morning.

The nurse smiled, the kind of smile that carried good news gently. "She delivered safely," she said. "A healthy baby boy. The doctors and midwives worked together like a miracle that day."

I felt my heart lift.

The husband's pacing, the panic, the urgency — all of it had melted into joy.

I was told that the woman had arrived in distress, She had been managed by an inexperienced Traditional birth attendant and her labour complicated, her strength wavering. But the teamwork of the staff — the rapid response, the coordination, the silent communication, the readiness — had saved two lives that day.

At that moment, I understood something profound:

GMC was not merely a hospital. It was a sanctuary of partnership, expertise, compassion, and divine timing.



Working in GMC opened my eyes to the quiet heartbeat that drives this place—a heartbeat steady as the evening gong in an Igbo square, calling people together in trust and purpose. In the first weeks of my work, I began to understand that Goodwill Medical Centre is not just a hospital; it is a living spirit, a community shelter, a place where science and compassion sit side-by-side like old friends.

There is a gentleness here—an honesty in the way nurses bend toward patients, the way doctors speak softly yet firmly, the way the cleaners move like dawn breeze, wiping away dust before it even settles. Every corridor carries its own quiet story. If one listens well, one can almost hear them: footsteps of mothers, the hopeful breath of newborns, the whispered prayers of families who have walked long roads seeking help.

It was in this atmosphere that I began to understand why GMC exists. Goodwill Medical Centre is driven by a mission that is simple, yet powerful enough to bend the arc of a community toward hope: To deliver compassionate, affordable healthcare while promoting integrity, peace, and goodwill among all who walk through our doors. The mission lives not only in documents or signposts—it lives in people.



In the pharmacist handing medication with patience.

In the laboratory scientist who double-checks results like someone guarding the moon.

In the doctor who refuses to give up on a child burning with fever.

In the health educator who visits local churches to teach and warn and protect.

GMC's mission is not spoken; it is performed—daily, quietly, consistently.

And with each passing day, I began to uncover the stories, the sacrifices, and the small miracles that shaped this place long before I arrived.

In the early days of my work, curiosity followed me like a loyal companion. I asked questions, sometimes timidly, sometimes boldly—and in the answers I received, I discovered a world woven with purpose.

One afternoon, during a quiet moment in the pharmacy, I asked a senior nurse:

"How did all of this begin?"

She smiled the way one smiles when remembering a child who has grown tall.

And she told me.

She told me about the early days when access to the hospital was difficult, when the Avah River swallowed pathways and delayed care. She told me how pregnant women, sick children, and elders sometimes stood helpless on the riverbank.

But she also told me how GMC, with support from its donors, constructed a bridge for the Iffo Community and its surrounding settlements, a sturdy path that now carries people to safety, to healing, to hope. I imagined villagers crossing at dawn, the air still cool, carrying their children or worries across that bridge—the bridge that now stands like a promise carved into the land.

That story stayed with me.





Just outside the main building, I discovered the Antenatal Care Centre, a modest structure blessed with warmth. The entrance is lined with carefully tended flowers—yellow and pink, standing like cheerful sentries.

Every Monday and Saturday, pregnant mothers gather there, sitting with round bellies and soft chatter, waiting to receive their health education before treatment. From afar, it looks like a garden of hope—women glowing with expectation, holding their bellies as if cradling tomorrow.

I learned that this clinic was constructed within GMC's first six months, following a recommendation from the Executive Secretary of the Enugu State Primary Healthcare Development Agency (ES-PHCDA).

What began as a suggestion became a sanctuary.

Opposite the pharmacy—just across the passage that smells faintly of disinfectant and fresh floor polish—is the Eye Clinic. Every Tuesday and Thursday, it buzzes with life.

Elders wipe their eyes, children squint with curiosity, traders sit fanning themselves softly. The optometrists and ophthalmologists move with quiet precision, like sculptors restoring clarity. Three times a month, the eye theatre comes alive with cataract surgeries—lifting the night from people’s eyes, giving them back their world. The first 20 surgeries, I learned, were sponsored generously by TYDF, and since then the unit has flourished like a plant that finally found water.

I also discovered the Paediatric Care Unit, where the cries of newborns blend with the soft reassurances of mothers. GMC’s team of paediatricians, nurses, and support staff provide 24-hour care. Within months, 77 children under five had received life-saving interventions.

Often, I pause at the entrance just to witness the tiny miracles happening inside.



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I soon learned that GMC is accredited under the:

NHIA – National Health Insurance Authority

ESAUHC – Enugu State Agency for Universal Health Coverage

CEMoC – Community Emergency Maternal and Obstetric Care Insurance

These names may sound official, but their meaning is simple:

No one should be denied care because of poverty.

Through these insurance schemes, I watched families walk in with worry and walk out with relief.

GMC also covered 60 community members under NHIA by August 2024—people who had never imagined they could ever afford insured healthcare.

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GMC staff visit faith-based organizations, spreading health education like seeds.

From hypertension awareness to maternal health teachings, they go where the people gather.

The hospital is not a building; it is a movement.

Twice in the year, the hospital organized massive free medical outreaches.

In January, 839 people received care—medications, glasses, walking aids, tests.

In May, another 421 were treated.

I love watching the crowds arriving—women balancing children on their hips, men steadying frail parents, youths guiding the elderly by the elbow. It felt like a festival of healing.

5 years from now, I hope to see

- A modern specialist hub with upgraded theatres and diagnostic centers
- A fully expanded Eye Health Complex serving thousands yearly
- A digitized system linking pharmacy, laboratory, consultation, and outreach
- A thriving ambulance unit crossing the Iffo Bridge at any hour
- A vast network of school health programs reaching beyond Enugu State
- A maternal centre where childbirth is safe, dignified, and joyful
- Insurance access extended widely to the most vulnerable families
- And a hospital campus that grows into a health village—a place where hope is not scarce, but abundant.

Working at Goodwill Medical Centre has taught me that the strongest institutions are not built only on concrete or equipment, but on compassion.

On vision.

On the quiet labor of people who believe that every life matters.



GMC is not just treating patients;
it is building a future—one mother,
one child, one family, one
community at a time.

And as I walk its halls each day, I
am reminded that goodwill is not
just the center's name.

It is its identity.

Its calling.

Its gift to the world.

GMC PHARMACY TEAM 2025

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